The Life You *Choose*

THE MADE REAL BLUEPRINT / PHASE 1

I stay in the town I know, *and I get my evenings back.*

I work four days, and the fifth day is outdoors. I am outside every day, even when the weather is bad.

Sam · In 8 weeks

01 Picture
In the first week

02 Explore
In the first week

03 Decide
In 8 weeks

WHAT I AM CHOOSING NOW

The town where I live. Go and change where I am.

One full month on four-fifths pay, with the rent and the bills paid out of it.

1

condition still open

In the first week

first action

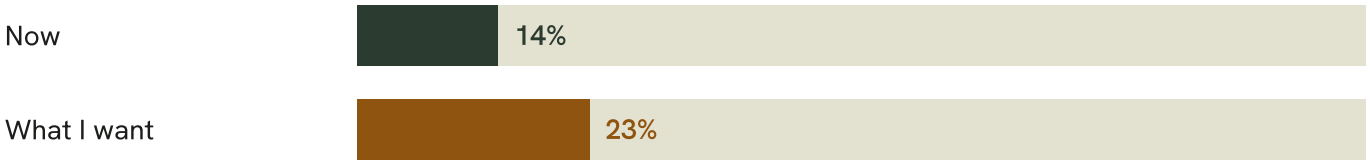
My own answers across the three steps of Phase 1, gathered on one document. It shows what I think today, with the open work visible. It is not advice, and it is not a recommendation to move.

WHAT I AM CHOOSING

Keep the life in the plan

Health, Freedom, Family, Nature, Simplicity. The change is only worth it if ordinary days make more room for these.

TIME I DECIDE FOR MYSELF



16 of my 112 waking hours a week are mine to choose today. The second figure is what I am aiming at.

WHAT I NEED / WHAT THE RESEARCH FOUND

Daylight after work, most days	Yes	Known
One whole day a week outdoors	Yes	Estimate
Rent I can pay without counting	Yes	Known
My sister within half an hour	Yes	Known
A patch of ground of my own	Partly	Estimate

WHAT I PROTECT / WHAT I ACCEPT

My job and the people in it. My flat and the rent I can afford. My sister ten minutes away. The Thursday market. Knowing the chemist by name.

Being the one who answers in the evening. The idea that the life I want is somewhere abroad. Two hours a day on screens that are not work.

I will know it worked if a normal Friday is spent outside and I have stopped reading about other people's countries.

03 / MONEY

What the numbers can carry

Monthly costs €2,198

Income I can count on €2,360

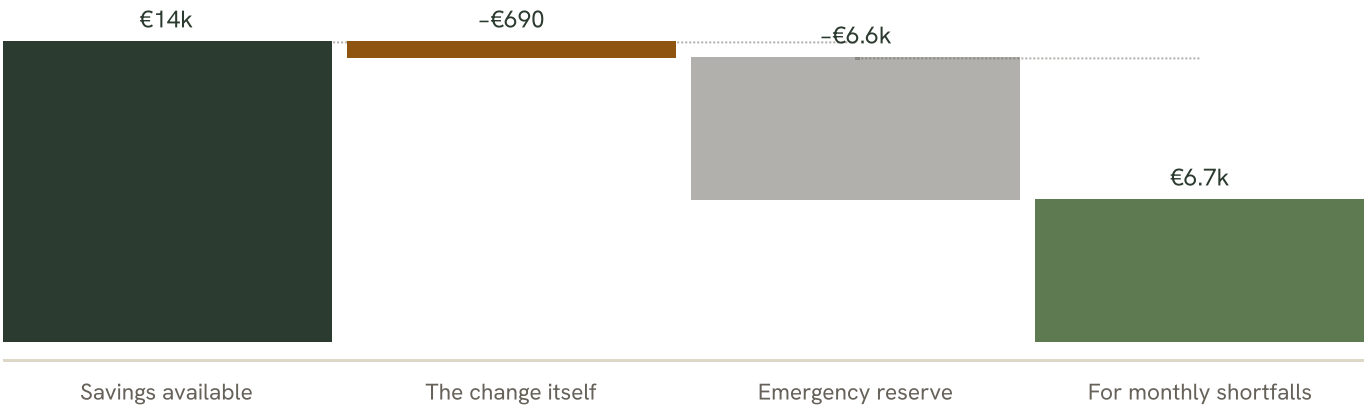
€162

left over each month

On the income I can count on today.

Step 1 guessed €2,210 a month. Step 2 found €2,198, 1% less.

HOW €14,000 BECOMES €6,710 TO LIVE ON



6

months I want

If everything costs 30% more: Costs €2,873 and I am €513 short each month. The reserve covers about 13 months. I would go back to five days for a season rather than spend it.

My runway divides the money left to live on (€6,710), not my savings: the reserve and the return fund are kept out of it on purpose. Nothing here is advice; these are my own figures.

MY NEXT CHAPTER

Prepare, check, then commit

Money	Papers	People	Place	Plan B
Amber	Green	Green	Green	Green
One full month lived on €2,360, with the rent and the bills paid out of it	Nothing to arrange. Same country, same contract, same address	My sister knows, and my manager has agreed to a meeting	I stay in the flat I know, at the rent I know	Four days is reversible, and the reserve is untouched

The colours are my own answers on the day. Nothing here says that anything is ready.

OPEN CONDITIONS

- **Money** — After the first month
  One full month lived on €2,360, with the rent and the bills paid out of it

MY FIRST ACTION

Ask my manager for a meeting about a four-day week., before In the first week.

A flat no from work with no room in it, or a month on the lower pay that does not add up.

MY WAY BACK

Not needed. The equivalent is the reserve, and the fact that four days is reversible.

I look at this decision again on In 8 weeks. Dealbreakers I carry forward: A week with no daylight in it. Moving away from my sister. Rent I have to think about on the first of the month.

IF I AM STAYING

My change plan

Four days a week in the same job, with Friday outdoors, and two evenings a week that end at six.

In place by the fourth month.

1

FIRST WEEK

Ask my manager for a meeting

What must be true first: A month of figures I believe

2

FIRST MONTH

Live on four-fifths pay on paper

What must be true first: Last three months of spending in front of me

3

SECOND MONTH

Put the request in writing

What must be true first: A yes in principle

4

THIRD MONTH

Take a corner of a neighbour's allotment

What must be true first: Tools and boots

5

FOURTH MONTH

First Friday outdoors

What must be true first: The change in place

MONEY AND BUFFER

€2,360 a month from the fourth month, confirmed, against €2,210 of costs. The buffer stays at €6,600, three months of everything, untouched.

HOURS I DECIDE, BEFORE AND AFTER

About 16 hours a week now. About 26 after the change.

IF I AM STAYING

Who it rests on, and the way back

WHO I TELL

My sister first, then my manager, then the team. From my sister I need a standing Friday, so somebody is expecting me.

MY FIRST 90 DAYS

Week one, the meeting. After 30 days, two evenings a week that really end at six. After 90 days, the request agreed and in writing.

MY PLAN B

If four days is refused, I keep the two evenings and ask again after six months, with one unpaid day a month meanwhile. If the lower pay does not add up, I go back to five days for a season rather than spend the reserve.

I look at this again: the third month after the change, and again after a year. Staying is a decision like any other, and this is the plan that goes with it.